

LEADERSHIP

There are many definitions of leadership, one of which is that: Leadership is the process of inspiring, influencing and guiding others to participate in a common effort. To encourage participation, leaders supplement any authority with their personal attribute, vision and social skills. A leader is someone who able to inspire, influence and guide others to achieve a common goal.

Leadership can be divided into two, formal and informal leadership. Formal leadership is the process of influencing others to pursue official objectives, while informal leadership is the process of influencing others to pursue unofficial objectives that may or may not serve the organization's interests. Formal leaders have formal authority, unlike informal leaders.

There are theories that have evolved such as the following: Trait, Behavioral styles, situational and Transformational approaches.

TRAIT THEORY

The assumption in trait theory is that leaders are born and not made. One psychologist observed that leadership traits are not completely inborn, but can also be acquired through learning and experience. Research shows that good leaders usually displayed traits such as intelligence, energy, persistence, ambitious, dependable, cooperative, tolerant to stress, self-confident, adaptable to situation, decisive, assertive, creative, organized, persuasive willing to assume responsibility.

BEHAVIOURAL STYLES THEORY

This theory concentrated on the behavior of the leader rather than the characteristics of successful leaders. There are three classic leadership styles that were identified in one laboratory study. The three are democratic/participative, authoritarian/autocratic and laissez-faire/free reign styles.

Behavioural theories attempt to identify behaviours that differentiate effective from ineffective leaders. One key question is; do leaders tend to be more democratic than autocratic? Under this theory, once behaviour for good leaders is found, people can be trained to be leaders.

Ohio State Studies and the Michigan University, which led to the development of what is called the managerial grid, have carried out a number of studies.

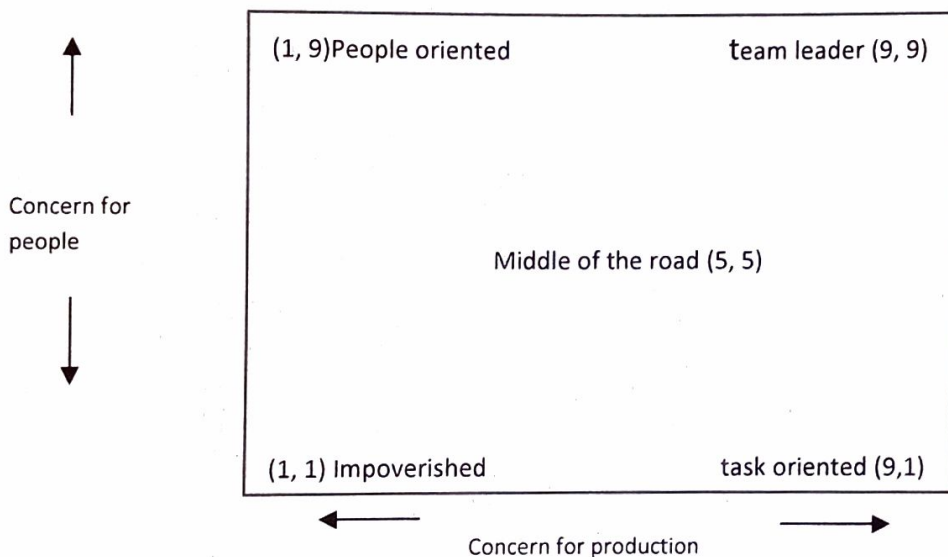
The **Ohio State Studies** focused on two dimensions namely initiating structure and consideration. The initiating structure is the extent to which a leader defines and structures his or her role and those of subordinates to attain goals. The dimension of consideration is the extent to which a person has job relationships characterised by mutual trust, respect for subordinate's ideas and regard for their feelings.

A leader who is high on initiating structure and consideration (thus the high-high leader achieved high subordinates performance and satisfaction more frequently than one who rated low on either considerations or initiating structure or both.

The **University of Michigan Studies** main objective was to locate behavioural characteristics of leaders that were related to performance effectiveness. Two dimensions of leadership behaviour were labelled employee oriented and production oriented. Employee oriented leaders were described as emphasising interpersonal relationship; they took a personal interest in the needs of their subordinates and accepted individual differences among members.

Managerial Grid

Blake and Mouton based the managerial grid on a two-dimensional view of leadership style as developed. It is based on "concern for people" and "concern for production"



Using this matrix, Blake and Mouton identified five key positions on the managerial grid are as follows:

Grid 1,1 Impoverished: this is where the leader exerts a minimum effort to accomplish the work;

Grid 9,1 Task. The leader concentrates on task efficiency but shows little concern for the development and morale of subordinates;

Grid 1,9 Country Club. The leader focuses on being supportive and considerate of subordinates to the exclusion of concern for task efficiency;

Grid 5,5 Middle of the road. The leader maintains adequate task efficiency and satisfactory morale;

Grid 9,9 Team. The leader facilitates task efficiency and high morale for coordinating and integrating work-related activities.

Following the studies, Blake and Mouton concluded that managers perform best when using Grid 9, 9 style. The approach did not answer the question of what makes a good leader but merely a framework concept for leadership style.

iii) Contingency theories

In the study of leadership, it became very clear that predicting leadership success involved something more complex than isolating a few traits or preferable behaviours. The failure to obtain consistent results led to a new focus on situational influences. The relationship between leadership style and effectiveness suggested that under condition *a*, style *x* would be appropriate, whereas style *y*, would be more suitable for condition *b*, and style *z* for condition *c*.

Various studies in contingency theory were undertaken. The foremost proponent of the theory was Fred Fiedler.

a) Fiedler's Contingency Model

The Fiedler Contingency model assumed that effective groups depend on a proper match between a leader's style of interacting with subordinates and the degree to which the situation gives control and influence to the leader. Fiedler developed the **least-preferred co-worker (LPC) questionnaire**, which purports to measure whether a person is task or relationship oriented. He isolated three situational criteria namely leader-member relations, task structure and position power. He believed that these criteria could be manipulated to create the proper match with the behavioural orientation of the leader.

Leader-member relations: *The degree of confidence, trust and respect subordinates have in their leader.*

Task Structure: *The degree to which the job assignments are proceedurised or structured or unstructured.*

Position Power: *The degree of influence a leader has over power variables such as hiring, firing, discipline, promotions and salary increases.*

b) House's Path-Goal Theory

House focused on what leaders can do to motivate their subordinates to achieve group and organizational goals. The premise of path goal theory is that effective leaders motivate subordinates to achieve goals by (1) clearly identifying the outcomes that subordinates are trying to obtain from the workplace, (2) rewarding subordinates with these outcomes for high performance and attainment of work goals and (3) clarifying for subordinates the paths leading to attainment of work goals. The theory is a contingency model because it proposes that steps managers should take to motivate subordinates depend on both the nature of

subordinates and the type of work they do. Based on the expectancy theory of motivation the path goal theory provides managers with three guidelines to follow to be effective leaders.

- a. Find out what outcomes your subordinates are trying to obtain from their job and the organisation
- b. Reward subordinates for high performance and goal attainment with the outcomes they deserve.
- c. Clarify the paths to goal attainment for subordinate, remove any obstacles to high performance and express confidence in subordinate's capabilities

The Path-Goal identifies four kinds of leadership behaviours that can motivate subordinate;

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- Directive behaviour
 - Supportive behaviour
 - Participative behaviour
 - Achievement- oriented behaviour
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